volcanoes in the world, such as Mt. Stromboli in Mediterranean Sea, St.Helens in USA, Pinatubo in Philippines. Mauna Loa in Hawaii is the world's biggest active volcano.



Stramboli is known as the 'light house of Mediterranean sea'

2. Dormant Valcano

These volcanoes have shown no sign of activity for many years but they may become active at any time. These are called Sleeping Volcanoes. Mt. Vesuvius of Italy, Mt. Fujiyama of Japan, Mt. Krakatoa of Indonesia are famous examples of this types.

3. Extinct volcano

A Volcano has not erupted in past 1000 years is often listed as Extinct volcanoes. The top of extinct volcanic mountains have been eroded. Mt. Popa of Myanmar, Mt. Kilimanjaro and Mt. Kenya of Africa are examples of extinct volcanoes.

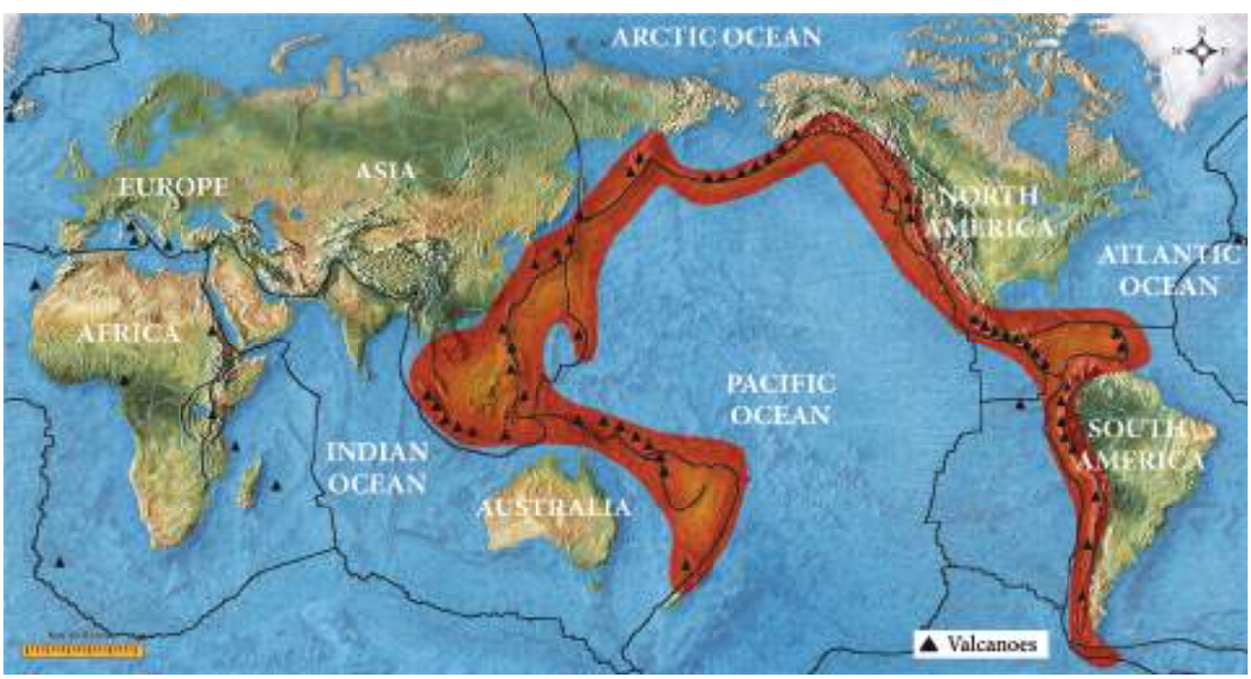
Distribution of Volcanoes in the world

Volcanoes are located in a clearly-defined pattern around the world. They are closely related to regions that have been intensely folded or faulted. There are about 600 active volcanoes and thousands of dormant and extinct ones. They occur along the coastal mountain ranges, as off-shore islands and in the midst of oceans, but there are a few in the interior of continents. The volcanic belts are also the principal earthquake belts of the world. There are three major zones of volcanic activities in the world. They are:

1. The Circum – Pacific belt
2. The Mid continental belt
3. The Mid Atlantic belt

1. Circum Pacific Belt

This is the volcanic zone of the convergent oceanic plate boundary. It includes the volcanoes of the eastern and western coastal areas of Pacific Ocean. This zone is popularly termed as the Pacific Ring of Fire which has been estimated to include two-thirds of the world's volcanoes.



Pacific Ring of Fire

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